installations as well as abducting and executing various officials.[66] They also began employing suicide attacks against security forces there and in the NWFP. Yet another peace agreement followed in September 2006. Known as the Waziristan Accord, and signed in North Waziristan, it was intended to end all fighting between pro-Taliban militants and the government. This brought a momentary calm to North and South Waziristan, but also enabled the burgeoning TTP movement to expand further. Their growing strength, coupled with the Taliban's resurgence in Afghanistan, invigorated the wider Pakistani jihadi community. In the years immediately prior, the security services were coming down particularly hard on those who openly affiliated with al-Qaeda and many militants from various groups had gone underground. Now there was a sense the tide was shifting, and militants were once again letting their jihadi flag fly.

A proto-insurgency was clearly extant by this time. The event that precipitated its extension beyond the Tribal Areas and severed any remaining ties between Pakistan and many of its former proxies took place in Islamabad. The leadership of the pro-Taliban Lal Masjid [Red Mosque] located there had been challenging the government over a host of issues, including implementing sharia in Pakistan and ending support for the US. The Lal Masjid included a male madrassa [Jamia Faridia] and a female madrassa [Jamia Hafsa], and the army had used it since the 1980s to recruit fighters for proxy jihads in Afghanistan and Kashmir. However, its leaders also had strong ties to the militants in FATA who were a war with the state and by 2007 the Lal Masjid was considered a potential threat to Pakistan's capital city. Fearing government action against their alma mata, former students who had earlier joined various Deobandi outfits began holing up in the mosque in spring of that year.[67] Meanwhile, the leadership continued to agitate for sharia while their students harassed local businesses deemed un-Islamic. Lashkar's leaders initially supported the call by clerics at the Lal Masjid for sharia, but as the situation devolved they distanced themselves from the agitation, claiming no group had the right forcibly to implement sharia in Pakistan.[68] On 3 July 2007 a series of provocations led to a gun battle between members of the Lal Masjid and Pakistan security forces. Soldiers surrounded the mosque and imposed a curfew, but also offered amnesty to those who surrendered. The siege lasted a week. Then, on the morning of 10 July, Pakistani commandos launched an assault. Casualty figures vary and conspiracy theories abound regarding how many died